

Wegovy (semaglutide) Tablets for Weight Management

Patient Group Direction, version 006, issued 9 September 2026. Oral semaglutide 1.5mg, 4mg, 9mg and 25mg. Adults 18 to 85.

Three things changed in this version. Read them before supplying.

- **THE STOPPING RULE IS NOW ONE RULE.** Version 004 gave two different ones in different boxes. See "Review and the stopping rule" below.
- **BASELINE WEIGHT MUST BE RECORDED AT INITIATION** and carried forward at every visit. The 5% test is meaningless without it, and version 004 never asked for it.
- **SWITCHING FROM THE INJECTION NOW REQUIRES DOCUMENTED EVIDENCE** of the current injection dose. Patient self-report is not sufficient.
- **The GLP-1 exclusion now reads "for any indication".** The correction notice issued on 7 September 2026 is incorporated here and is withdrawn.

Initial assessment

Before commencing treatment the patient must be assessed by a registered healthcare professional. The initial assessment should be face to face and should include, but need not be limited to:

- Causes of weight gain. Refer to the GP if a prescribed medicine is causing weight gain.
- The patient's lifestyle, diet and level of exercise.
- Whether the patient has tried to lose weight before, and what has and has not worked.
- Other factors that may be contributing, including mental health, environmental and psychological factors. Consider signposting to another health professional.
- Other disease states that may predispose to weight gain. Consider referring to the GP.
- The patient's expectations of weight loss, and whether they are realistic.
- **Height, weight and BMI. RECORD THE WEIGHT AS THE BASELINE. Set a realistic target weight and agree review intervals.**

Wegovy (semaglutide) tablets

Patient Group Direction for the supply of oral semaglutide 1.5mg, 4mg, 9mg and 25mg tablets for weight management in adults aged 18 to 85 years.

Healthcare professionals covered, and training

- Pharmacist registered and practising with the GPhC.
- Pharmacy technician registered and practising with the GPhC.
- All users must be familiar with the current SPC for the product supplied, the BNF and applicable national guidance.
- All users must be competent in weight management consultation, BMI calculation and the recognition of red flags requiring referral.
- All users must be able to explain the empty-stomach administration requirements and check at each visit that they are being followed, because absorption depends on them.
- All users must know how to obtain and verify documentary evidence of a previous injection dose before switching a patient from the injection.
- All users must previously have supplied medicines under a PGD.
- All users must be up to date with CPD and appraisal, and with MHRA safety alerts, including the strengthened GLP-1 pancreatitis warning of 29 January 2026.
- All users must understand capacity and consent and be aware of the Mental Capacity Act 2005.
- All users must hold appropriate indemnity covering this service, must work in compliance with the SOPs of their own employer, and must practise only within the bounds of their own competence.

The PGD

Indication	Wegovy (semaglutide) tablets are a UK-licensed oral GLP-1 receptor agonist indicated as an adjunct to a reduced-calorie diet and increased physical activity for weight management, including weight loss and weight maintenance, in adults with an initial BMI of 30 kg/m ² or above (obesity), or 27 kg/m ² to below 30 kg/m ² (overweight) in the presence of at least one weight-related comorbidity, for example hypertension, dyslipidaemia, obstructive sleep apnoea, cardiovascular disease or type 2 diabetes. This medicine is subject to additional monitoring (black triangle); report all suspected adverse reactions via the MHRA Yellow Card scheme.
Inclusion criteria	• Adults aged 18 to 85 years inclusive. • BMI 30 kg/m² or above, or BMI 27 kg/m² or above with at least one weight-related comorbidity. • Baseline weight measured and recorded at initiation, and available at every subsequent visit. • Willing to follow a reduced-calorie diet and increase physical activity in line with the agreed lifestyle plan. • Initial assessment completed and documented. • Able to follow the empty-stomach administration requirements: a fast of at least 8 hours before the dose, and a 30 minute wait afterwards before food, drink or other oral medicines. • Informed consent obtained, including the side-effect profile and treatment expectations. • Where switching from the injection: documented evidence of the current injection dose obtained and recorded. See the switching row below. • No exclusion criteria present.
Exclusion criteria	• Under 18 years of age. • Over 85 years of age. This is a Get Real Health position, not a licence restriction; the SPC sets no upper age limit and records only that experience above 85 is limited. Refer to a specialist if treatment is being considered. • Pregnancy, breastfeeding, or planning pregnancy. Effective contraception is required throughout. Semaglutide must be discontinued at least 2 months before a planned pregnancy because of its long half-life, and stopped immediately if

	pregnancy occurs or is suspected (SPC section 4.6). • Known hypersensitivity to semaglutide or to any of the excipients. • Personal or family history of medullary thyroid carcinoma, or Multiple Endocrine Neoplasia syndrome type 2. • History of pancreatitis, acute or chronic. • Severe gastrointestinal disease, including gastroparesis or a severe persistent gastrointestinal disorder. • Current cholelithiasis or cholecystitis, or cholecystectomy within the last 3 months. • Obesity caused by an endocrinological disorder. Where the patient was already overweight before that diagnosis, this exclusion may not apply. • CONCURRENT USE OF ANY OTHER GLP-1 RECEPTOR AGONIST OR INSULIN SECRETAGOGUE, FOR ANY INDICATION. Ask specifically whether the patient takes anything for diabetes, and name the products. Several GLP-1 medicines are licensed for type 2 diabetes as well as for weight management: orforglipron for both, oral semaglutide separately for diabetes at 3mg, 7mg and 14mg, and semaglutide and tirzepatide injections in diabetes. A patient does not always think of a diabetes medicine as the same kind of drug. • Type 1 diabetes mellitus. • Diabetic retinopathy. Treatment may worsen retinopathy; defer or refer to a specialist. • On insulin or a sulphonylurea where the GP is unwilling to monitor and adjust the hypoglycaemic regimen. • Severe renal impairment (eGFR below 30 mL/min/1.73 m²) or end-stage renal disease. • Severe hepatic impairment. • Known heart failure with reduced ejection fraction below 40%. • Active eating disorder: anorexia nervosa, bulimia, or binge-eating disorder under specialist care. • BMI below the inclusion threshold. • Switching from the injection where documented evidence of the current injection dose cannot be obtained. • Patients who, in the clinical judgement of the healthcare professional, are not suitable for the medicine.
Switching from semaglutide injection	DOCUMENTED EVIDENCE IS REQUIRED. Patient self-report of the injection dose is not sufficient and must not be relied on. Acceptable evidence, one of: • A dispensing label, prescription, or repeat slip showing the strength. • A record from the supplying clinic or pharmacy, including a GRH consultation record. • The patient's own pen or carton, seen by the pharmacist, with the strength legible. • Written or verbal confirmation from the prescriber, recorded with the date and the name of the person who gave it. Record which of these was seen, and the strength it showed. A photograph on a phone is acceptable where the strength is legible. Where the documented dose is 2.4mg once weekly: • Start Wegovy tablets at 25mg once daily, one week after the last injection. Where the documented dose is LOWER than 2.4mg once weekly (0.25mg, 0.5mg, 1mg or 1.7mg): • Do NOT start at 25mg. There is no licensed switch from these doses and 25mg would be a substantial jump. • Either continue the injection under the original prescriber until 2.4mg is reached and then switch as above, or start the tablets

	as a new initiation at 1.5mg once daily, one week after the last injection, and titrate monthly through 4mg and 9mg to 25mg. • Explain to the patient that starting again at 1.5mg is not a step backwards but the only safe route, and that the titration protects them from gastrointestinal effects. • This lower-dose pathway is a Get Real Health practice decision, not a licensed instruction. Record it as such. Where the injection was stopped more than 2 months ago, treat as a new initiation and apply the BMI inclusion criteria afresh.
Review and the stopping rule	ONE RULE. Version 004 said "6 months on the maintenance dose" in two places and "6 months on the maximum tolerated dose" in a third. The rule is now: Reassess whether to continue where the patient has lost less than 5% of their BASELINE body weight after 6 months at their established dose. • "Established dose" means 25mg once daily where the patient reached it. • Where the patient did not reach 25mg because of tolerability, it means the highest dose they have tolerated for at least 3 consecutive months. A patient who never reaches 25mg is not thereby exempt from review, which was the practical effect of the "maintenance dose" wording. • The 5% is calculated from the recorded baseline weight, not from the weight at the last visit. Where no baseline was recorded, one must be established and the 6 months run from that point. At every visit: • Reassess clinical benefit, tolerability and progress against the agreed target weight. • Record weight, and the percentage change from baseline. • Confirm the empty-stomach administration requirements are being followed, since absorption depends on them. • When the patient reaches their target weight, discuss whether to continue to maintain it.
Cautions	Counsel on gradual dose escalation and gastrointestinal side effects. Consider delaying titration or reducing to the previous dose if significant symptoms occur. ACUTE PANCREATITIS. The MHRA strengthened the class warning for GLP-1 receptor agonists on 29 January 2026 after reports of necrotising and fatal cases. Make the red flag explicit to the patient: severe, persistent abdominal pain, often radiating to the back, means stop the medicine and seek urgent medical attention the same day. History of suicidal ideation, or active severe mental illness. Ensure appropriate psychiatric oversight is in place, monitor mood at review, and refer if there is any concern. Do not supply where oversight is absent and concern exists. Non-arteritic anterior ischaemic optic neuropathy has been reported with semaglutide. Advise the patient to seek urgent review for any sudden loss of vision, and discontinue if it is confirmed. Mild to moderate renal impairment: monitor for dehydration secondary to gastrointestinal side effects. Delayed gastric emptying may reduce the absorption of oral medicines, especially those with a narrow therapeutic index. On starting semaglutide in a patient on warfarin, frequent INR monitoring is recommended. Decreased INR has been reported with acenocoumarol, so the same applies to other coumarins. Levothyroxine: oral semaglutide increases levothyroxine exposure by about a third (AUC increased 33%). Monitor thyroid function when the two are taken together, and make sure the patient keeps the 30 minute separation, which matters more here than with most co-medicines. Pulmonary aspiration has been reported in patients on GLP-1 receptor

	agonists undergoing general anaesthesia or deep sedation. The increased risk of residual gastric content from delayed gastric emptying should be considered before any such procedure. Advise the patient to tell any anaesthetist that they take this medicine. For patients who take HRT, given the lack of absorption data, non-oral products such as a patch, gel or levonorgestrel intrauterine device may be considered. Tachycardia has been reported. In a patient with a pre-existing raised heart rate, use with caution and seek specialist advice first. Discontinue and seek advice for a clinically relevant sustained rise in resting heart rate. Sulfonylurea or insulin co-use in comorbid type 2 diabetes carries a hypoglycaemia risk. Refer to the prescribing GP or specialist before starting. Risk of dehydration. Counsel on adequate fluid intake during gastrointestinal side effects. The 25mg maintenance tablet contains 23mg of sodium. The lower strengths are essentially sodium free. Rarely material, but worth knowing for a patient on a sodium restricted diet.
Actions if the patient is excluded or declines	• Discuss the reason for exclusion and make sure the patient understands it. • Advise on alternatives and how to access them: the GP, a specialist weight management service, or a lifestyle programme. • Where the exclusion relates to an undiagnosed or unmanaged comorbidity, recommend GP review. • Where the exclusion is that injection-dose evidence could not be obtained, tell the patient exactly what to bring, so the appointment can be rebooked rather than abandoned. • Document the advice given and the decision reached. Inform or refer to the GP as appropriate.

The medicine

Name, form and strength	Wegovy (semaglutide) tablets: 1.5mg, 4mg, 9mg and 25mg. Black triangle medicine subject to additional monitoring. Record the product name and batch number for traceability.
Legal category	POM.
Storage	Store in the original package below 30 degrees Celsius to protect from moisture. Keep the container tightly closed.
Route and method of administration	• Oral, once daily, on an empty stomach after a fast of at least 8 hours, with no more than half a glass of water, about 120 mL. • Wait at least 30 minutes before food, drink or other oral medicines. • Swallow the tablet whole. Do not split, crush or chew. • Only one tablet per day. Never combine tablets to approximate a higher dose.
Dose and frequency	• Start at 1.5mg once daily for one month. Escalate monthly through 4mg and 9mg to the maintenance dose of 25mg once daily, with a minimum of one month at each step. The dose may be held at the previous level if needed. • Maximum dose 25mg once daily. • Missed dose: skip it and take the next dose the following day. Never take two tablets in a day to make up a missed dose (SPC section 4.2). • Where several consecutive doses have been missed, use clinical judgement about restarting at a lower step and re-escalating. That is a practice decision rather than a licensed instruction. • For significant gastrointestinal symptoms during titration, consider

	delaying a dose increase or dropping to the previous dose until symptoms improve. • To recommence after stopping, titrate again from the lowest dose. Apply the BMI inclusion criteria afresh if more than 2 months have passed since discontinuing. • Switching from the injection: see the switching row above. Documented evidence of the current injection dose is required.
Quantity to be supplied	• One calendar pack of 30 tablets at the appropriate strength, giving one month of treatment. • Supply one month of treatment per patient appointment. • This PGD does not allow additional medicine to be supplied to enable a patient to stock up.
Adverse effects	Very common: nausea, diarrhoea, vomiting, constipation and abdominal pain. Common: dyspepsia, eructation, flatulence, gastro-oesophageal reflux, gallstones, headache, fatigue, dizziness, hypoglycaemia when used with a sulfonylurea or insulin, hair loss and tachycardia. Uncommon or rare: acute pancreatitis, cholecystitis, hypersensitivity reactions including anaphylaxis, acute kidney injury usually secondary to dehydration, and non-arteritic anterior ischaemic optic neuropathy. Refer to the current SPC for full safety information.
Yellow Card reporting	Report suspected adverse reactions via https://yellowcard.mhra.gov.uk and inform the GP as appropriate.
Records to be kept	• That valid informed consent was given. • Patient name, address, date of birth, and the GP with whom they are registered. • Name of the healthcare practitioner, and registration number. • Name and brand of the medicine, and the batch number. • Date of supply, dose, form, route and quantity supplied. • BASELINE WEIGHT, recorded at initiation and carried forward at every visit thereafter. • Height, weight and BMI at this visit, the percentage change from baseline, and the target weight agreed. • Where switching from the injection: what documentary evidence of the injection dose was seen, and what strength it showed. • The current established dose, and where it is below 25mg, how long the patient has been on it. • Confirmation that the empty-stomach requirements are being followed. • Advice given, including advice given if the patient is excluded or declines. • Details of any adverse drug reactions and the actions taken. • That the medicine was supplied under this PGD. Records signed, dated, legible and contemporaneous. Electronic records are acceptable. Adults aged 18 and over: keep for 8 years.

Information for the patient

Written information	Supply the patient information leaflet provided with the medicine, together with written lifestyle, diet and physical activity advice and the agreed target weight.
Counselling	• Take one tablet a day on an empty stomach, after at least 8 hours without food, with no more than half a glass of water. Wait 30 minutes before anything else, including other tablets. • Swallow whole. Do not split, crush or chew. Never take two in a day. • The medicine works alongside diet and activity, not instead of them. • Nausea and other stomach effects are common at first and usually settle. Drink enough fluid.

	● Tell any anaesthetist, dentist or surgeon that you take this medicine before any procedure with sedation or a general anaesthetic.
Follow-up and urgent symptoms	Seek urgent medical attention the same day for: ● Severe, persistent abdominal pain, often going through to the back. Stop the medicine. ● Persistent vomiting with signs of dehydration. ● Yellowing of the skin or the whites of the eyes. ● Sudden loss of vision in one or both eyes. ● A sustained rise in resting heart rate. Attend for review as agreed. Treatment will be reassessed if less than 5% of your starting weight has been lost after 6 months at your established dose.

Appendix 1: Key references

- Summary of Product Characteristics for the product supplied, current version.
- NICE guidance on obesity management and on the relevant medicine.
- MHRA Drug Safety Update, GLP-1 receptor agonists and acute pancreatitis, 29 January 2026.
- Other MHRA Drug Safety Updates relevant to GLP-1 receptor agonists.
- British National Formulary.
- NICE Medicines Practice Guideline 2 (MPG2): Patient Group Directions, <https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/mpg2>

Authorisation

Version	v006
Supersedes	Version 005, 8 September 2026
Valid from date	9 September 2026
Expiry date	31 July 2027

Doctor	Name: Nitin Shori Job title: Medical Director, Get Real Health GMC: 6047293 Signed: N. Shori Date: 9 September 2026
Pharmacist	Name: Chris Pilkington Job title: Head Pharmacist, Get Real Health GPhC: 2046322 Signed: C. Pilkington Date: 9 September 2026

Both authorising signatories reviewed this version together on 9 September 2026 and gave their authorisation for it to be issued. Signatures were applied digitally on their joint instruction, which is the established process for Get Real Health PGDs.

Adoption by the employing organisation

To be completed by the adopting pharmacy. These signatories are the adopting organisation own signatories and must not be pre-filled by Get Real Health.

Superintendent / clinical lead	Name: Job title and organisation: Signature: Date:
Professional group signatory	Name: Job title and organisation: Signature: Date:

Change history

Version	v006
Date	8 September 2026
Changes	• The practitioner Agreement to practise page, the premises block and the practitioner signature table are restored. Every version 001 document carried them; no document produced by the current generator did, through one omission in one function, which left 15 live documents with no page for an individual practitioner to sign. Raised as blocking by an adopting pharmacy: NICE MPG2 expects a record of the individuals authorised to work under a PGD. The standard governance requirements are restored at the same time: SPC and BNF familiarity, MHRA safety alerts, CPD and appraisal, indemnity, and capacity and consent, all of which were in version 001 and were lost in the rewrite. This version changes no clinical content. • The stopping rule is now a single rule. Version 004 stated "6 months on the maintenance dose" in the cautions and in the patient follow-up advice, and "6 months on the maximum tolerated dose" in the monitoring section. It now reads: reassess where less than 5% of baseline body weight has been lost after 6 months at the established dose, being 25mg where reached, or the highest dose tolerated for at least 3 consecutive months where it was not. A patient who never reaches 25mg is no longer exempt from review. • Baseline weight must be recorded at initiation and carried forward at every visit, and the 5% is calculated from it. The 5% test existed in version 004 but nothing required the baseline it depends on to be recorded. • Switching from semaglutide injection now requires documented evidence of the current injection dose. Patient self-report is not sufficient. Four acceptable forms of evidence are listed and the one relied on must be recorded. • A pathway is stated for patients switching from an injection dose below 2.4mg, which version 004 did not cover at all. Do not start at 25mg: either continue the injection to 2.4mg under the original prescriber, or start the tablets as a new initiation at 1.5mg and titrate. Marked in the document as a practice decision rather than a licensed instruction. • The concurrent GLP-1 exclusion now reads "for any indication", closing the gap where a patient taking a GLP-1 for type 2 diabetes was not caught by an exclusion limited to weight management use. The correction notice issued on 7 September 2026 is incorporated and withdrawn. • Requirement added to advise the patient to tell any anaesthetist, dentist or surgeon that they take this medicine before a procedure under sedation or general anaesthetic, the pulmonary aspiration point having previously appeared only in the cautions to the pharmacist. • Records section expanded to require baseline weight, percentage change from baseline, the evidence seen for a previous injection dose, and the current established dose with its duration.

Previous versions

001	Development and issue of new PGD.
004, 21 August 2026	Reconciled against the UK SPC published after v003 was signed: levothyroxine interaction added, missed dose instruction corrected to the licensed wording, MHRA January 2026 pancreatitis warning added, and the tirzepatide clause removed from the pregnancy exclusion.

Standard requirements for every practitioner working under this PGD

All users must be familiar with the current Summary of Product Characteristics for every product named in this PGD, and with current BNF and national guidance for the condition.

All users must be up to date with MHRA drug safety alerts and recalls relevant to these products.

All users must be up to date with their CPD requirements and appraisal.

All users must hold appropriate professional indemnity covering this service.

All users must understand capacity and consent, including the Mental Capacity Act 2005, and must be able to assess consent in children and young people where this PGD covers them.

Agreement to practise by the registered healthcare professional

By signing below you confirm that you agree to the contents of this PGD and that you will work within it. A PGD does not remove the inherent professional obligations or accountability of the individual practitioner. It is the responsibility of each healthcare professional to practise only within the bounds of their own competence and professional code of conduct.

Name and address of the pharmacy or clinic premises to which this PGD relates

Premises name
 Address
 Postcode:
 ODS code, if applicable

Registered healthcare professionals authorised to work under this PGD at those premises

The employing organisation must keep this page, or an equivalent local register, and must be able to produce it on request. A practitioner who has not signed against the current version is not authorised to work under it.

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